

UI & UX Design Checklist

A review pass for layout, typography, states, accessibility and performance.

Hierarchy & layout

- One clear primary action per screen; secondary actions are visually quieter.
- Align everything to a spacing scale (4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 24 / 32 / 48 px).
- Group related controls; separate unrelated groups with whitespace rather than lines.
- Keep line length between 45 and 80 characters for comfortable reading.

Typography

- Use at most two families and a strict size ramp (12 / 14 / 16 / 20 / 24 / 32).
- Body text at 16px minimum on the web; line height 1.4–1.6.
- Avoid full-black text on white — #101828 on #ffffff reads softer.
- Never use colour alone to convey meaning.

Colour & contrast

- Body text needs a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1; large text 3:1.
- Interactive targets should be at least 44 × 44 px on touch screens.
- Reserve one accent colour for actions and highlights.
- Gradients, shadows and animation should be purposeful, not decorative.

States — the part most builds forget

State	What the user must see
Loading	Skeleton or spinner that matches the final layout
Empty (no data)	Explanation plus the action that creates the first item
No results (filtered)	The active filters and a one-click way to clear them
Error	Plain-language cause and a retry path
Success	Confirmation that names what changed
Not found	A route home, not a dead end

Accessibility

- Every interactive element is reachable and operable by keyboard.
- Visible focus ring on all focusable elements — never outline: none without a replacement.
- Images have alt text; decorative images use alt="".
- Inputs have real labels, not placeholder-only hints.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion for larger transitions.
- Icon-only buttons need an aria-label.

Responsive behaviour

- Design mobile-first, then widen: 360 / 768 / 1024 / 1440 px breakpoints.
- No horizontal scrolling at any width; test long unbroken strings.
- Tables collapse to cards or scroll inside a labelled container.
- Touch targets stay large when the layout compresses.

Performance budget

- Lazy-load images below the fold; size them to their display box.
- Keep the initial JavaScript payload small — code-split routes.
- Avoid layout shift: reserve space for media and fonts.
- Measure with Lighthouse on mid-tier hardware, not just a fast laptop.